

Organization Reference — The Cormsil Compact

DA reference: milestone descriptions with cross-link instructions. Read when a milestone square is reached on the Operations Board.

01 — The Returned (Val 6, Active)

The 25 library fire victims. Embodied by fragments of the Dömere. Initially passive — daily visits to Eleanor Vane. Escalating as the spirit's awareness grows. They are not conscious villains — they are vessels who don't understand what they are.

01M1 (Day 7): The returned begin coordinating. They visit Eleanor in groups. They speak in unison without realizing they're doing it. The skeptical townsfolk notice and become alarmed. → **I8 becomes available. Advance 02 by 1.**

01M2 (Day 4): The returned stop pretending to be normal. They gather at the burned library every evening, standing in a circle, facing inward. They don't speak. They just stand. Eleanor stops leaving her house entirely. → **I12 becomes available. Advance 04 by 2 (Eleanor deteriorates rapidly).**

01M3 (Day 2): One of the returned — Margaret Hale, a former schoolteacher — breaks from the group. She approaches the agents. She says she remembers dying. She says she knows what she is. She offers to help. → **I16 becomes available. The volunteer for the silencing ritual is now available.**

02 — The Skeptical Townsfolk (Val 7, Active)

A loose coalition of Cormsil residents who don't believe the "miracle" story. Led by Tom Dwerryhouse, a local farmer whose wife Mary is among the returned — and he knows the woman in his house is not his wife.

02M1 (Day 6): Dwerryhouse approaches the agents. He's been keeping notes — documented the tells: the blinking, the cold skin, the unison speech. He knows something is wrong. He'll share everything if agents are straight with him. → **I6 becomes available. Dwerryhouse becomes an ally. L7 (the standing stone) location revealed — it's in his field.**

02M2 (Day 3): The skeptics attempt to confront the returned at the library. It goes badly. The returned speak in unison for the first time consciously — a single voice from 25 mouths: "We are the balance. Do not interfere." The skeptics are terrified but now have undeniable proof. → **I14 becomes available. The town's division becomes open conflict.**

03 — The Society's Trail (Dormant, Val 5)

Dormant until: (a) agents find the Society's manual in the church crypt, or (b) agents discover the first reference to The Society in the vicar's papers at the Bodleian. The Society is a shadowy Victorian organization that brokered the 1882 compact — almost nothing is known about them.

03M1 (Day 6): The Society's manual is found. It's a handwritten field guide — Victorian, practical, unsettlingly knowledgeable. It describes the Dömere, negotiation methods, and references "Colne's manuscript" and "the standing stone at Cormsil." → **I10 becomes available. The manual is the key operational document for the case.**

03M2 (Day 3): The vicar's letter at the Bodleian provides context: The Society was organized, secretive, and effective. The letter mentions "the volume I have hidden" — confirming the manual was left deliberately. The

letter also notes that The Society "has no name worth recording, for they prefer to remain unremembered." → **I15 becomes available. The Society remains a mystery but their methods are now clear.**

04 — Eleanor Vane (Val 4, Active)

The librarian. Responsible for the library fire — fell asleep, a scented candle ignited a stack of books. Being visited daily by 25 people who "forgive" her. Has not slept in over three weeks. Deteriorating physically and psychologically.

O4M1 (Day 8): Eleanor stops sleeping entirely. She's been awake for 19 days. She's lucid but fragile. She tells agents everything — the candle, the fire, the people running into the woods, the visits. She says: "They don't want me to die. They want me to *know*. And I do. I know. I've known since the first one walked through my door. But knowing doesn't stop them coming." → **I4 becomes available.**

O4M2 (Day 5): Eleanor collapses — not physically, psychologically. She becomes catatonic for several hours, then wakes and begins writing. She writes the same sentence over and over: "The stone is warm. The stone is warm. The stone is warm." She's never been to the standing stone. She doesn't know what it means. But the spirit is speaking through her now. → **I11 becomes available. The standing stone's location is revealed — the Dömere is using Eleanor as a conduit.**

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